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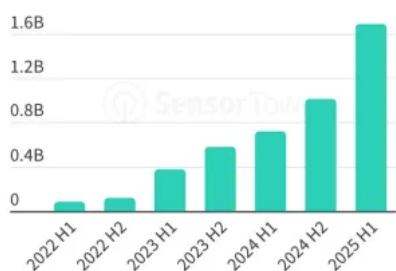


GenAI apps doubled their revenue, grew to 1.7B downloads in first half of 2025

Generative AI apps have seen tremendous growth in both downloads and in-app revenue in the first half of 2025, [a report](#) from market intelligence firm [Sensor Tower](#) said. Users downloaded GenAI apps 1.7 billion times, compared to 1 billion in H2 2024. These apps doubled in-app revenue, bringing in \$1.87 billion in H1 2025, as compared to \$932 million in H2 2024.

The report noted that users spent over 15.6 billion hours on GenAI apps in the first half of 2025, a jump from 8.5 billion hours in H2 2024. This time was recorded over 426 billion sessions.

Downloads



IAP Revenue (USD)

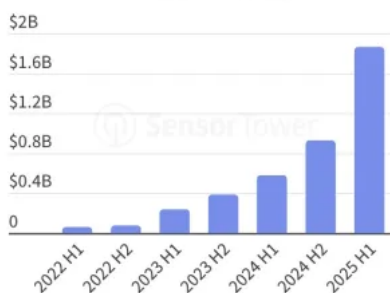


IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

Asia was the fastest-growing market for GenAI apps, and also took the lead for market share in terms of downloads with 42.6%, thanks to markets like India and Mainland China. Download growth in Asia was 80% in H1 2025, as compared to 51% in Europe and 39% in North America.

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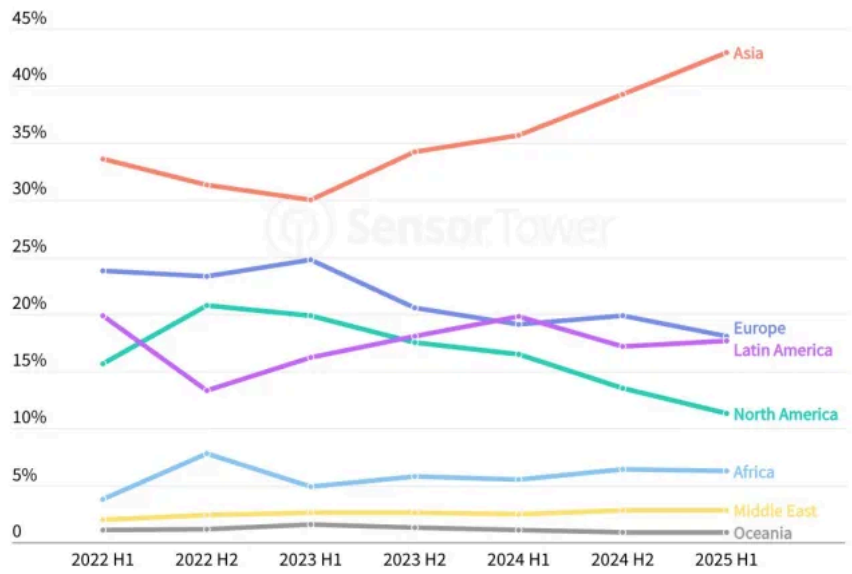
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- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
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IMAGE CREDITS:SENSOR TOWER

While LatAm registered the highest growth for in-app purchases for GenAI apps, North America still holds the lead in terms of market share with 40%.

ChatGPT's continued growth

Sensor Tower noted that ChatGPT was the leading app for in-app revenue in every country, bar China. However, China's DeepSeek performed better in terms of the number of downloads in weeks after the launch.

People are also spending more time with different AI assistants, with ChatGPT leading the pack. People used the app for more than 12 days on average in a month for H1. Other popular apps were Character AI, PolyBuzz, DeepSeek, and Perplexity.

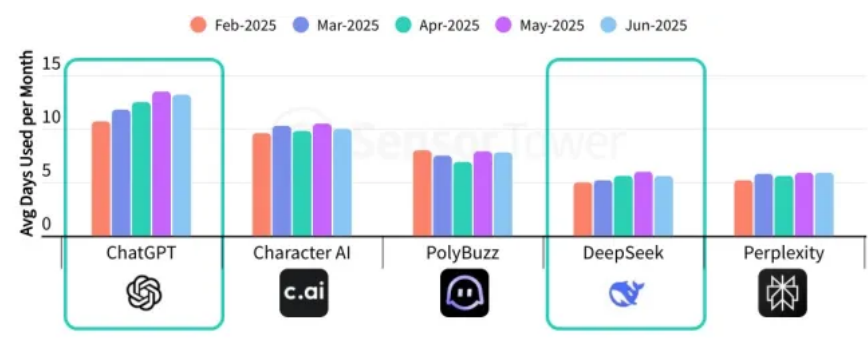


IMAGE CREDITS:SENSOR TOWER

ChatGPT’s stickiness has been impressive. Sensor Tower said that people are using OpenAI’s app as much as X and Reddit. Only Google has a better rate for the average number of days used per month. The report also mentioned that, as compared to last year, ChatGPT’s weekend usage has also improved, signaling that people are relying on the AI-powered chat app beyond work.

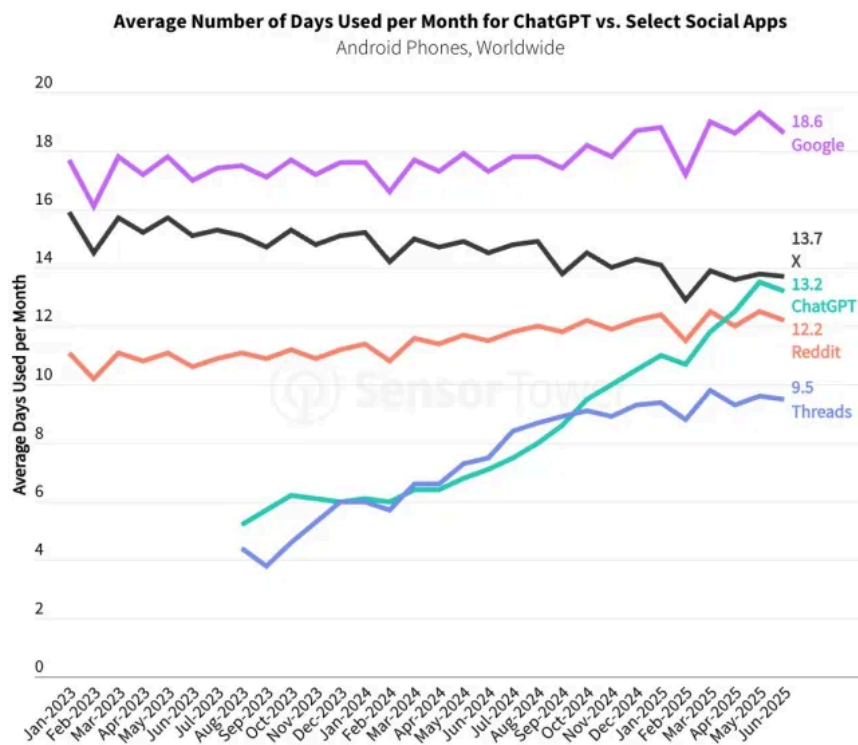


IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

“This development makes its app usage patterns more akin to Google’s, which consumers rely on as a primary search tool both during and outside of work hours,” the report said.

Over time, the gap between usage of ChatGPT and usage of apps in the top search engine and browser categories has decreased. For instance, in H1 2025, ChatGPT had 16 minutes of average daily usage as compared to 18.2 minutes for the top search engine and browser.

Browser & Search Engine App Engagement vs. ChatGPT

Worldwide, iOS and Google Play

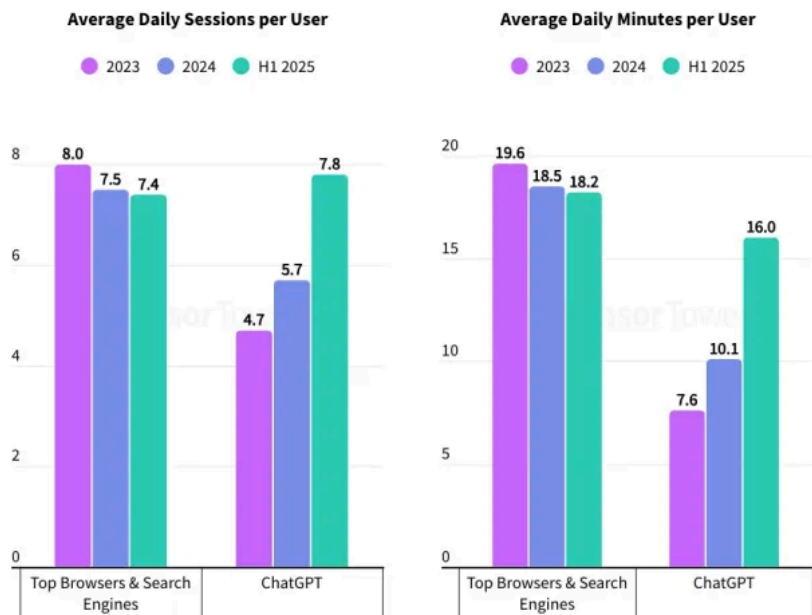


IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

Beyond search, users are also using ChatGPT for health and wellness, shopping, personal finance, and meal prep advice. The report said that more than a third of prompts used on ChatGPT in Q2 2025 were related to lifestyle and entertainment.

Sensor Tower noted that ChatGPT is gaining users across both mobile apps and platforms. It said that more than 15% of ChatGPT users in the U.S. access it across the web and mobile, higher than other platforms like Temu and Threads. While ChatGPT has shown progress, it is still behind other platforms like Google, Facebook, YouTube, Google Docs, and Amazon, which have more than 25% of users accessing the service both on the web and mobile.

Apps are adding “AI,” literally

The intelligence firm said in its report that the term AI now appears over 100,000 times in app descriptions on both the App Store and the Play Store. Users downloaded apps mentioning AI 7.5

billion times in H1 2025, which accounted for around 10% overall downloads.

In the last 12 months, a growing number of apps in categories like AI assistant, AI content generation, Photo Editing, Nutrition & Diet, Test Prep, Tutoring & Studying, Translation, and Other Hobbies & Interest Services have added AI-related terms.

An increasing number of apps in the top charts for different categories now have “AI” in their names. However, this addition only has a short-term boost in downloads.

Median Download Growth vs. Month Before Adding AI-Related Terms
Worldwide



IMAGE CREDITS: SENSOR TOWER

“Unsurprisingly, apps that added terms like ‘AI’ or ‘LLM’ to their app names or descriptions experienced a notable boost in downloads over the subsequent months,” Sensor Tower said.

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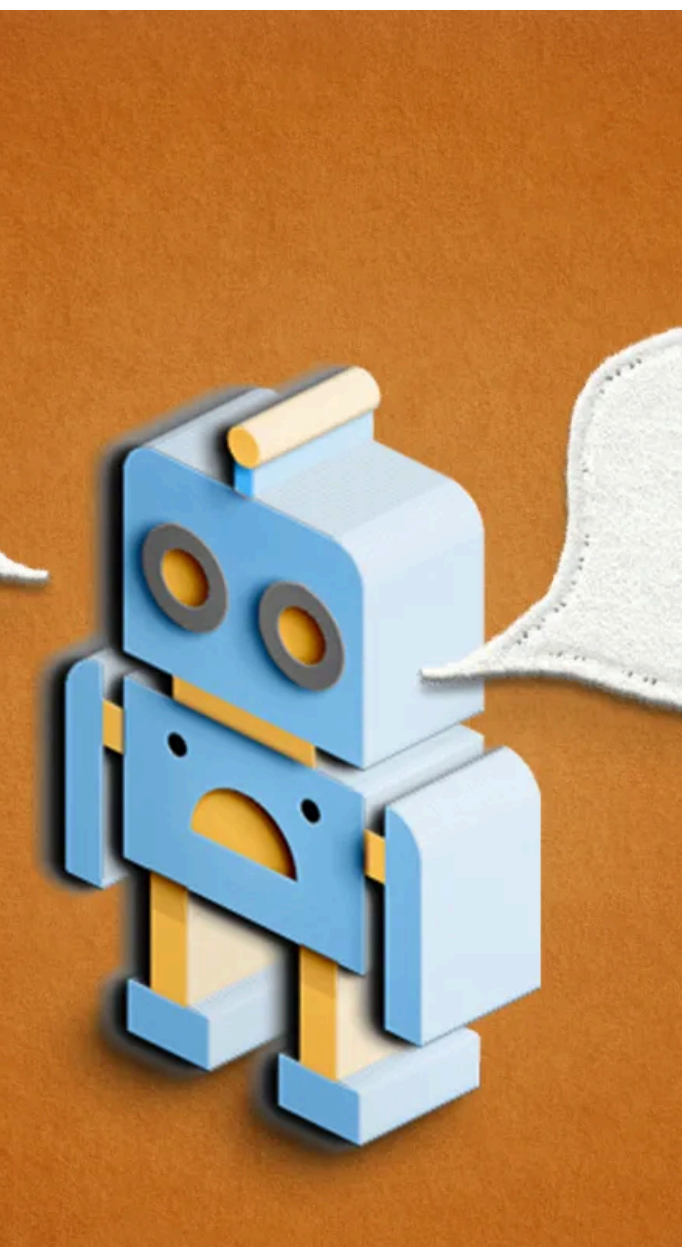


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AI



User spending goes up by more than 4000% on AI-powered apps

Ivan Mehta — 6:50 AM PDT · April 12, 2023

Given the rising interest in generative AI tools like text-based ChatGPT and image-based Midjourney, AI-powered apps are growing in numbers and popularity in both app stores.

A [report](#) by analytics firm Apptopia suggests that 158 AI Chatbot apps — with the description having keywords like “AI Chat” or “AI Chatbot” — hit the app stores in the first quarter of this year. That’s a 1480% increase year-over-year, mostly thanks to [OpenAI publicly releasing ChatGPT API in March](#).



The data suggests that multiple apps like Nova AI, Genie AI and Chat with Ask AI have broken into top charts in app stores — a lot of these apps are similarly named, so it’s easy to get confused between them. At the time of writing, [Chat with Ask AI](#) is on the top 10 free apps list on iOS in multiple countries.

Apptopia mentions in the report that developers are trying to convert AI chatbot tech, which is easily available on a web browser, into a native mobile experience and charging money for it. Most of the time these apps charge users for unlocking unlimited (or large number of) conversations with the chatbot.

Yalçın Özdemir, founder & CEO of AppNation, which makes Genie AI, told TechCrunch over an email that the app had over 2.5 million downloads in March. He said that the app now has more than 100,000 paid users and raked in \$1.5 million in revenue last month.

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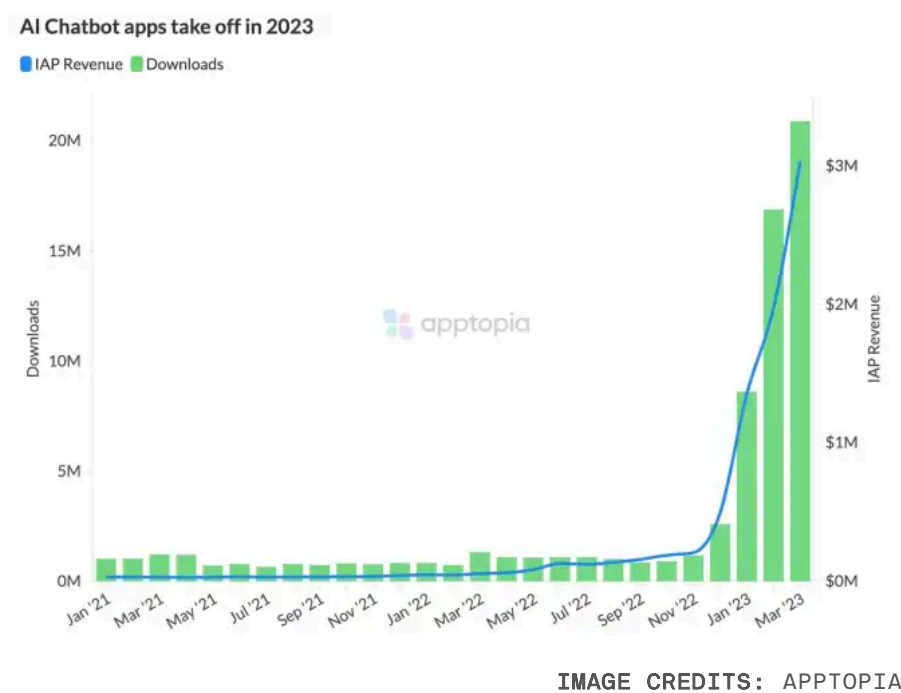
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The analytics firm noted that downloads for AI-powered apps have increased by 1506% year-on-year, with the number reaching nearly 20 million in March. The in-app spending has also increased, clocking almost \$3 million in March — a massive 4184% increase year-on-year.



Data compiled by Bernstein and app analytics company data.ai (formerly App Annie) paints a more rosy picture. It says that user spending on the top 10 GPT-3 powered AI apps reached \$6 million in February 2023.

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While most of these apps use the same base technology, they try and create differentiation by helping people with diverse prompts or by introducing multiple versions of bots with different abilities or moods. For instance, [Quora's Poe allows users to interact with multiple chatbots powered by ChatGPT, GPT-4, Claude and more](#). All these bots have different personalities, so you can interact with them for different use cases. Earlier this week, the app launched a new feature that [lets users create their own bots just using prompts](#). Some early examples include [a pirate language bot](#), a bot that [converts messages into emojis](#) and [a Japanese language tutor bot](#).

Apart from indie developers, this new popularity wave of AI-powered apps has also benefited Microsoft. The company announced the integration of [OpenAI tech with Bing](#) earlier this year. Apptopia said that since then, Bing's average daily downloads have increased by 1000%. While the search app got into the App Store's top charts in February, the rank quickly fell and the downloads still remain 1/10 of Google downloads, according to data.ai.

Bernstein’s analysis also suggests downloads for Microsoft’s Edge browser, which [also integrated an AI chatbot powered by OpenAI tech](#), jumped 135% year-on-year in Q1 2023. The firm said that the browser reached 1/3 of Chrome’s download volumes for this period.

Despite this rise in popularity, analysts at Bernstein are being cautious. They said that it is “too early to comment on whether any of these pure-play AI-assistant apps have staying power.” This signals that AI-powered chatbots are novel use, but the longevity of interest in them is yet to be tested.

But this onslaught of AI apps also brings dubious tools to the app stores. Last week, China-based tech giant Baidu sued Apple for allowing [counterfeit apps of its Ernie bot on the App Store](#). Earlier this year, many apps labeled “ChatGPT” flooded the App Store and the Play Store at a time when OpenAI hadn’t released an official API.

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Ivan Mehta

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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AI



Google saves your conversations with Gemini for years by default

Kyle Wiggers — 9:49 AM PST · February 8, 2024

IMAGE CREDITS:

ARTUR WIDAK/NURPHOTO / GETTY IMAGES

Don't type anything into [Gemini](#), Google's [family of GenAI apps](#), that's incriminating — or that you wouldn't want someone else to see.

That's the PSA (of sorts) today from Google, which in a new [support document](#) outlines the ways in which it collects data from users of its Gemini chatbot apps for the web, Android and iOS.

Google notes that human annotators routinely read, label and process conversations with Gemini — albeit conversations “disconnected” from Google Accounts — to improve the service. (It's not clear whether these annotators are in-house or

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Latest in AI

outsourced, which [might matter when it comes to data security](#); Google doesn't say.) These conversations are retained for up to three years, along with "related data" like the languages and devices the user used and their location.

Now, Google affords users *some* control over which Gemini-relevant data is retained — and how.

Switching off Gemini Apps Activity in Google's [My Activity](#) dashboard (it's enabled by default) prevents future conversations with Gemini from being saved to a Google Account for review (meaning the three-year window won't apply). Individual prompts and conversations with Gemini, meanwhile, can be deleted from the Gemini Apps Activity screen.

But Google says that even when Gemini Apps Activity is off, Gemini conversations will be saved to a Google Account for up to 72 hours to "maintain the safety and security of Gemini apps and improve Gemini apps."

"Please don't enter confidential information in your conversations or any data you wouldn't want a reviewer to see or Google to use to improve our products, services, and machine learning technologies," Google writes.

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To be fair, Google's GenAI data collection and retention policies don't differ all that much from those of its rivals. OpenAI, for example, saves all chats with ChatGPT for 30 days regardless of whether ChatGPT's conversation history feature is switched off, excepting in cases where a user's subscribed to an enterprise-level plan with a custom data retention policy.

But Google's policy illustrates the challenges inherent in balancing privacy with developing GenAI models that feed on user data to self-improve.

Liberal GenAI data retention policies have landed vendors in hot water with regulators in the recent past.

Last summer, the FTC [requested](#) detailed information from OpenAI on how the company vets data used for training its models, including consumer data — and how that data's protected when accessed by third parties. Overseas, Italy's data privacy regulator, the Italian Data Protection

Authority, [said](#) that OpenAI lacked a “legal basis” for the mass collection and storage of personal data to train its GenAI models.

As GenAI tools proliferate, organizations are growing increasingly wary of the privacy risks.

A recent [survey](#) from Cisco found that 63% of companies have established limitations on what data can be entered into GenAI tools, while 27% have banned GenAI altogether. The same survey revealed that 45% of employees have entered “problematic” data into GenAI tools, including employee information and non-public files about their employer.

OpenAI, Microsoft, Amazon, Google and others offer GenAI products geared toward enterprises that explicitly *don’t* retain data for any length of time, whether for model training or any other purpose. Consumers though — as is often the case — get the short end of the stick.

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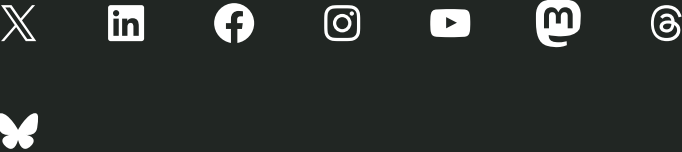
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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025.
His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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